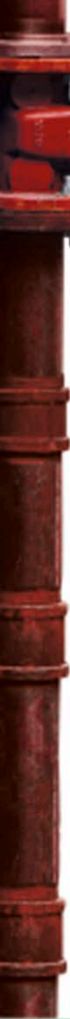
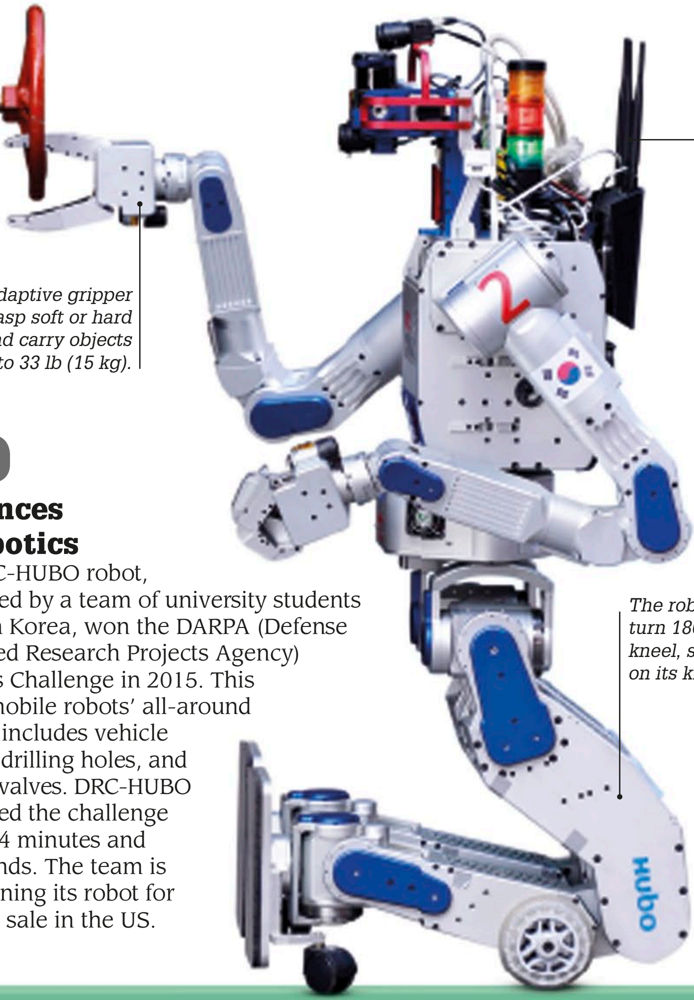




Greenland shark
In 2016, researchers discovered that the Greenland shark is the longest living creature with a backbone, with a lifespan of almost 400 years.

2016

Advances in robotics

The DRC-HUBO robot, developed by a team of university students in South Korea, won the DARPA (Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency) Robotics Challenge in 2015. This test of mobile robots' all-around abilities includes vehicle driving, drilling holes, and turning valves. DRC-HUBO completed the challenge in just 44 minutes and 28 seconds. The team is now refining its robot for possible sale in the US.

In 2016, Japanese scientists discovered the first species of bacteria (*Ideonella sakaiensis*) able to break down certain types of plastic.

2016

Oculus Rift

The Oculus Rift virtual reality headset was released by an American company called Oculus. Designed to offer an immersive experience for gaming, architecture, and design, the headset displays two 1,080 × 1,200 pixel high-resolution images that a set of lenses focus and reshape for each of the user's eyes to create a 3-D picture.

Gamer uses Oculus Rift headset

2016

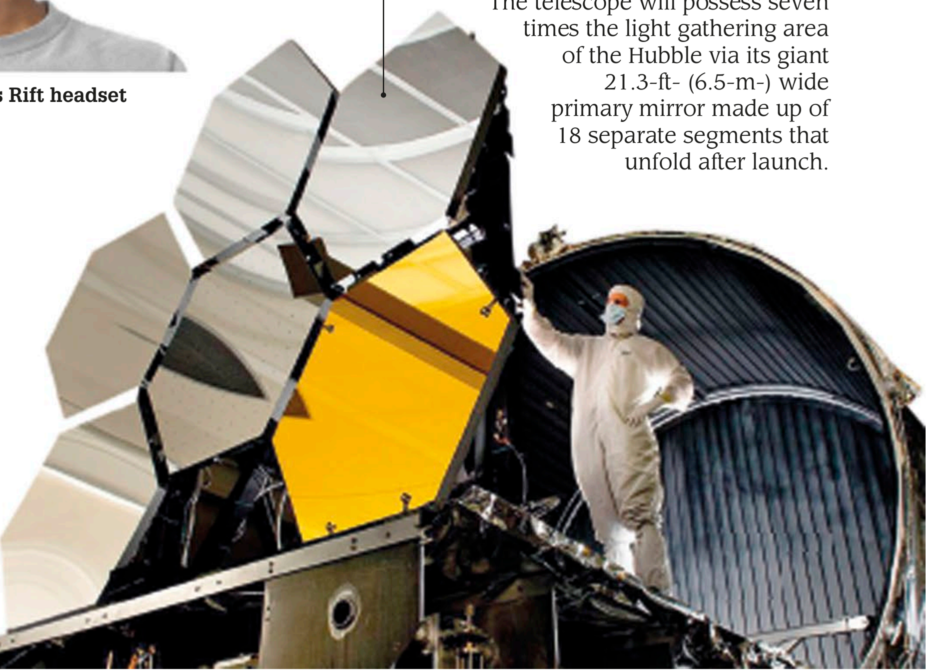
Thin solar cell

In 2016, scientists at MIT (Massachusetts Institute of Technology), produced a solar cell about $\frac{1}{50}$th the thickness of a human hair. It is light enough to sit on a soap bubble without popping it.

2018

James Webb Space Telescope

This successor to the Hubble Space Telescope will be launched in 2018. The James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) will feature an infrared instrument that can observe 100 different objects simultaneously. The telescope will possess seven times the light gathering area of the Hubble via its giant 21.3-ft- (6.5-m-) wide primary mirror made up of 18 separate segments that unfold after launch.



Six of the JWST's primary mirror segments